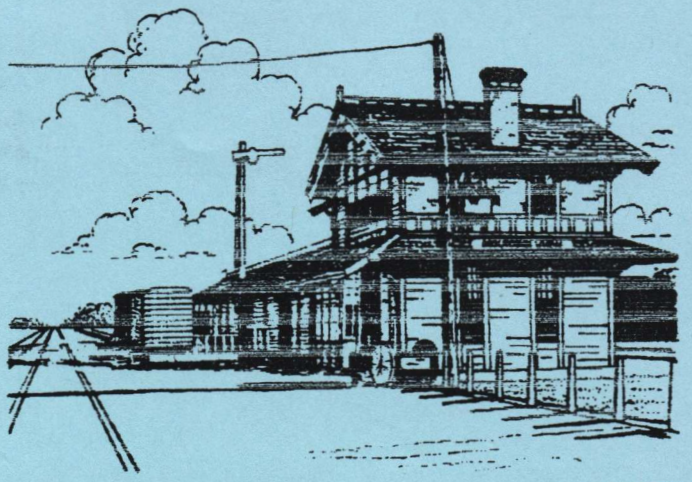
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

The May Meeting Celebrations 150 Years - First Presbyterian Church 100 Years - Saint Joseph Catholic Church

As the City of Mountain View approaches its Centennial Celebration, two other institutions within the City are also celebrating. The *First Presbyterian Church of Mountain View* celebrates 150 years since its founding, and the *Saint Joseph Catholic Church* celebrates 100 years since officially becoming a Parish Church.

First Presbyterian Church of Mountain View, at 150 years, is thought to have been the first protestant church congregation between San Francisco and San Jose. Barbara Kinchen will present an illustrated history of the church, where and when it was founded, the various church buildings, their locations and some of the ministers who have served the church and its congregation.

Saint Joseph Catholic Church claims roots that go back even more than 100 years. It is now celebrating 100 years since it officially became a parish church. Nick Galliotto will be presenting an illustrated history of the Church.

The February Meeting Memories and Memorabilia

The meeting opened auspiciously with the announcement by President Ralph Faravelli that the Association had been promised a private donation of $ 50,000, to complete the work of getting the Mountain View Historical Association Centennial Book published.

Roberta and Joseph Sweeney were presented with a certificate commemorating their 65th Wedding Anniversary.

Our Program Chairs, Liz and Mario Ambra, then called upon the various persons who had brought mementos of yesteryear to share. It was a very interesting program and it brought back many memories from the past.

The meeting was adjourned and refreshments, served by Hospitality Chair Betty Engberg, were enjoyed by all.

Executive Committee Meetings

The Executive Committee has held two meetings since the last Newsletter was published. The Committee met January 31, 2001 primarily to discuss two issues. The first issue dealt with possible ways of financing the publication of the Association's *Centennial Book*. Soliciting private grants or donations was one alternative, or requesting an advance of some sort from the City was the other. President Faravelli was instructed to pursue both avenues.

It was unanimously decided that a proclamation honoring Roberta and Joe Sweeney upon their 65th wedding anniversary should be prepared and presented.

It was announced that the Adobe building will be completed around the end of April. The Association will consider moving its regular meeting place back to the Adobe. We also would like to have space available in the building for the display and storage of historical objects.

The Committee met again on March 15, 2001, primarily to discuss possible arrangements to be made with the Mountain View Centennial Celebration Committee and the City as to the management of major donations in support of the Centennial Celebration. The Association will offer its services as a Non-profit, 501 (c) (3) organization to receive and disperse these funds for a very nominal management fee.

President Faravelli announced that Peery Foundation and the Arrillaga Foundation had each contributed $25,000 to the Association to support publication of the *Centennial Book*. President Faravelli was directed to arrange for public recognition of these generous gifts, and the Committee unanimously extended Life Memberships to John Arrillaga and Richard J. Peery in gratitude for these contributions.

The Annual Barbecue will take place August 5, 2001. We will try to arrange for this event at the Adobe Building.

Check Your Address Label

The address label affixed to this Newsletter has a code on the upper right. It looks something like this;

-[2001][AF]

The number in brackets is the year, according to the Treasurer's records, through which your dues have been paid. For Life Members the year is [2099]. If the year on your label is [2000], or earlier, either there is an error in our records, or you owe us back dues. In either case, let us hear from you! If we don't hear from you, and you are delinquent in your dues, we will have to drop you from the next mailing. **Please! We don't want to lose you!**

Street Talk Puzzler

We didn't get any response to the *February Street Talk* question, and we are feeling a little lazy, so we will just append a little item and call the same question: The **August Street Talk Puzzler** is: For whom were Eunice, Franklin, Sleeper and Sladky Avenues named?

The Pickle Works
By Kathleen Lowe Owen

For many years Mountain View was the home of many canneries and food processing plants. One of those plants was known locally as the "pickle works". It was located at the corner of Franklin and Villa Streets. The first of several "pickle works" buildings was constructed in 1915 for the California Supply Company, a San Francisco canning firm. The plant was expanded throughout the 1920s until it became on of the largest employers in Mountain View during the period between the world wars.

California Conserving Company and Hunt Foods, Inc. also owned and operated the "pickle works" during it 47 years in Mountain View. California Conserving Company bought the plant in the 1940s and Hunt Floods Inc. was operating the plant by 1950. At one time more than 200 persons were employed during the peak season, which was June through September. At times there were as many as 30 year-round employees who maintained the property and equipment used in making pickles. In later years fewer individuals were employed because cucumbers were sorted at locations other than Mountain View. Many of the full time employees performed such specialized jobs as barrel making or coopering.

Most of the tomatoes and cucumbers processed during the 1920s and 1930s were grown on the Holthouse and Thompson ranches, which are now the site of Lockheed's Sunnyvale facility. Each year cucumbers were delivered directly to the factory and then prepared into various pickle products. These were placed in salt brine for up to three months. The pickles were brined in 5000-gallon wooden vats before being transferred to 500+ pound barrels. The barrels were shipped to other facilities where the pickles were bottled. Between 50 and 100 barrels were produced each day. Until the 1950s the plant also processed tomato catsup. Residents in Mountain View always knew when the tomatoes were in – steam rising from the cooking house at the plant carried the aroma all over town! Like the pickles, the catsup was either sold in bulk or shipped to other facilities for bottling.

In 1963 California Conserving Company transferred the machinery from this location to a new, modern plant in Fremont. The building was demolished by the City of Mountain View as part of a rehabilitation program. The current police and fire building later replaced it.

In Commemoration

May Thoza Bontempi — Born May 1, 1921 on the family ranch in Farmington, California. Died April 2, 2001. Moved to Mountain View in 1925. She spent her early life helping in the family cherry and apricot orchards. A graduate of Mtn. View High School where she was active in both band and orchestra. She attended San Jose State College and worked at Moffett Field during WWII, where she Don Lloyd. She is survived by second husband Vince Bontempi, daughter Lorie Roberson of Roseville, CA and son Tim Lloyd of Phoenix, AZ, five grand children, her sister Tillie Masse.

May was proud of her family's Portuguese heritage. She was an active member of St. Joseph Parish and the St. Joseph Players. May loved fine foods, travel, theater and beautiful flowers. She retired from Teledyne Semiconductor in 1979 She was a volunteer at the Mountain View Center for the Performing Arts until she was disabled by a stroke in 1998 She was a long time member of the Mountain View Historical Association..

Phyllis Milo — Died April 1, 2001 in Mountain View at age 79. Survived by husband Henry Milo Jr., of Los Altos, son Jeff Milo of Los Altos, daughter Linda Milo of San Jose, sister Doris White of Virginia, two grand children and a niece and nephew. A native of Philadelphia, PA. Employed as Secretary by various companies in the Mtn. View-Los Altos area. An active member of the Mountain View Presbyterian Church and a volunteer for the El Camino Hospital Auxiliary. She was a member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

Old Newspaper Items Compiled By Barbara Kinchen

125 Years Ago (1876): School children celebrated May Day with a picnic at Martin Murphy Ranch.
I.O.O.F. Lodge #214 was instituted in their new Enterprise Hall in Old Mountain View.

100 Years Ago (1901: The local W.C.T.U. (Women's Christian Temperance Union) was opposed to the cruel sport of coursing. (The sport of chasing the hare or similar game with greyhounds, who follow by sight instead of scent.)

A school census showed 352 students at Mountain View School and 36 at Whisman.

At a recent school board election, voters were asked if the wanted a local high school. One hundred twenty six voted yes and thirty four voted no. Next there will be a bond election. Now high school students go to San Jose or Santa Clara for their high school studies.

75 Years Ago (1926): Odd Fellows Lodge (I.O.O.F.) Celebrated its fiftieth anniversary with a picnic at Kendell Dell.

F.I. Campen's new Mountain View Theater opened on Saturday, May 8, showing Sally O'Neill in "Mike". Opening night prices were 50¢ and 75¢. The University Creamery, in the theater building, opened several days later specializing in malts, shakes, sandwiches and home-made candies. You could also buy a quart of milk for 10¢ or a quart of ice cream for 30¢. This was a branch of Palo Alto's University Creamery.

Kiwanis Club got its charter on May 29th.

Mountain View Credit Bureau was established.

Albert and Lawrence Armanini completed the pharmacy course at the University of California and passed the State Board Examinations with high honors.

Peter Owler set a record for service with Wells Fargo Express Co. He has worked seven days a week with no days off and no vacations in the 20 years he has been in Mountain View.

Richmond-Chase Cannery will employ 300 women and from 75 to 100 men for the apricot canning season.

St. Joseph Church will have a new organ in time for Palm Sunday services.

Dr. Robert Grant Aitken, father of high school teacher Max. Aitken, is Associate Director of the Lick Observatory at Mount Hamilton and world famous double-star observer and scientist.

Anway Undertaking Company's big grey hearse was badly damaged when struck by a truck, as it was turning into Woodland Cemetery in San Mateo County. Bay Hays, driver, was not injured nor was the casket and contents being transported.

50 Years Ago (1951): Voters passed all ballot measures for new police and fire stations and a sewage disposal plant.

On Memorial Day the V.F.W. dedicated a bronze plaque, placed in City Hall Park, to honor all who had served in the armed forces and in memory of those who had lost their lives.

Five thousand attended the 25th I.F.E.S. Portuguese Festival.

Al Pearce, new resident, opened a prune pitting and packing plant on Bayshore Highway. He also is in charge of auditions for the talent show of the upcoming Harvest Festival and will be Master of Ceremonies. (Perhaps you remember Al and His Gang on radio with Elmer Blur and Tizzics List.)

High school teachers and all non-certified employees will receive a $300 cost of living bonus next school year. This will boost teacher salaries to $227.60 - $298.53 a month.

25 Years Ago (1976): The first scheduled event of the new Shoreline Park was planned for the Memorial Day weekend - a professional rodeo with 200 cowboys competing for $10,000 prize money. Admissions were to help send ten high school students to Moun-

tain View's sister city, Iwata, Japan.

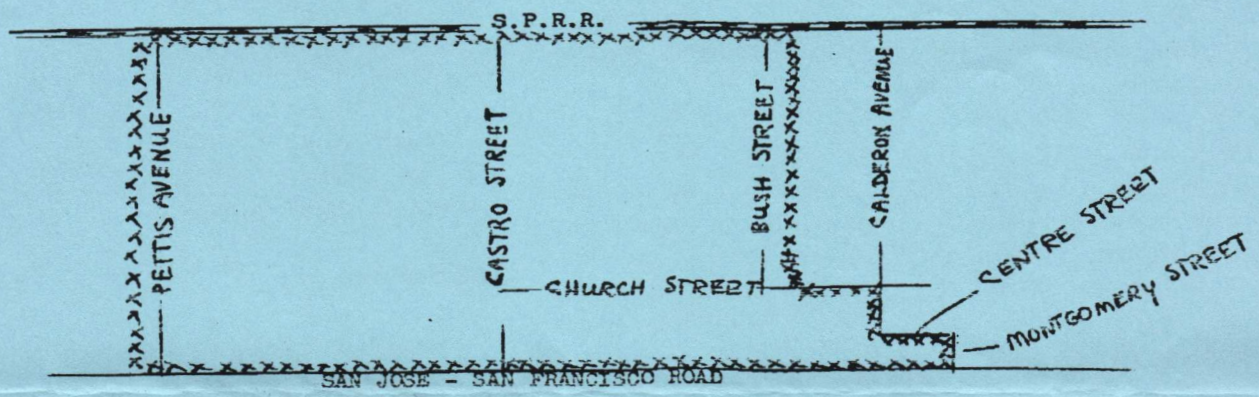
Mayor Katsumi Yamauchi of Iwata, assisted by Mayor Joe Perez, planted a cherry tree at City Hall to honor the first "Goodwill Mission" from Iwata, Japan.

The state legislature had passed a law permitting school districts to allow smoking in certain areas on school grounds.

After a trial period, Supt. Paul Sakamoto of the Mountain View-Los Altos High School District, declared that designated smoking areas had been successful and should be continued. Smoking had not increased and students no longer smoked in restrooms.

Bill Jelavich challenged the city's two-term limit for council but the State Supreme Court ruled it was constitutional. After 13 years on council, Jelavich had to step down.

The Centennial is Coming!



The above line is intended to mimic the nursery cry *The sky is falling!* The November, 1997 issue of this Newsletter included an article by Barbara Kinchen describing the birth and circumstances of the Municipal Corporation of Mountain View. Our date of birth is November 7, 1902, so our Centennial is less than two years away. The sketch above indicates the 1902 town limits, about one square mile, containing about 610 persons. We've come a long way, and our Centennial is worthy of some effort to understand and promote.

The petition asking for incorporation was signed by seventy two supporters. We published the names of half of them last issue. Here are the other 36. Does anyone have any insights or stories about these individuals? If you do, let us know and we will try to incorporate them into either future regular Newsletters, or a special edition

D. Murphy
L Hutchenson
Fritz Campen
M. J. Scarpa
J. S. Bailey
Toney Alves
H. D. Farr
John Morgan
W. A. Platt
C. Todd Clark
B. E. Burns
George W. Paden
H. W. Hickey
O. P. Askam
J. J. Connell
George A. Pattberg
John Burns
James Showers

G. K. Estes
F. L. Peterson
C. A. Fischer
J. Wellheimer
H. Trulson
C. G. English
M. A. Lewis
Geo. Spicer
Wm Howard
Edw. M. Ehrhorn
C. B. Baggl
C. C. Day
James Campbell
A. W. Erhorn
Otis M. Fellows
D. E. Morey
J. L. McPheeters
W. H. Serey

Treasurer's Report
Hilton Brown

Two actions have occurred during the past quarter which will significantly effect the financial operations of the Mountain View Historical Association.

First, the Mountain View City Council has asked the Historical Association to act as Custodian for major contributions which may be received in support of the City's Centennial Celebration. Since the Association is recognized by the IRS as a non-profit 501 (c) (3) Corporation, donors may be able to make tax exempt donations. The Association will establish a separate bank account, and will work closely with City Representatives to insure the integrity of all income and expenditures in this regard.

Second, the Association has received two gifts, totaling $ 50,000, from the Arrillaga Foundation and the Peery Foundation to support the publication of the *History of Mountain View*, a project the Association has been pursuing for almost two years. These restricted gifts will insure that a very professional well presented volume will be available for sale beginning with the City's Centennial Year.

The Association invests its surplus funds in Certificates of Deposit. As of March 31, 3001, the funds of the Association were distributed as follows:

Checking Account 3.52% APY	$ 55,510.14
Petty Cash	100.00
CD #420 4.65% Matures 9/25/01	2,638.18
CD #459 5.56% Matures 5/18/01	2,566.38
CD #474 5.61% Matures 6/18/01	2,567.46
CD #603 6.40% Matures 2/05/02	2,500.00
CD #634 5.54% Matures 2/02/02	2,500.00
Total	$68,282.61

Interest on the CD's is credited as they mature.

Income & Expense
January 1, 2001-March 31, 2001

Opening Balance		$ 18,255.26
Income		
Annual Dues	$ 137.00	
Life Members	400.00	
Interest	129.17	
Sales	23.60	
Restricted Gift	50,000.00	
Total Income		50,689.77
Expense		
Business Expense		
Donor Solicitation	200.00	
General Overhead	$ 101.16	
Meeting Expense	40.92	
Membership Expense	24.60	
Newsletter Expense	295.74	
Total Business Expense		662.42
Ending Balance		$ 68,282.61

Fund Balances
March 31, 2001

Fund Balances	
Adobe Fund	$ 1,078.73
Life Member Fund	7,832.00
Memorial Fund	519.14
Publication Fund	50,000.00
Operating Reserve Fund	3,000.00
Significant Debts Payable	3,656.25
Unencumbered (Equity)	2,196.49
Total Funds	$ 68,282.61

MVHA Equity on January 1, 2001 was $2,582.14, giving a net operating loss for the quarter of $ 385.65

Membership Report by June Casey

A list of members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Life Members	91
Special Member	1
Honored Member	1
Regular Memberships	205
Total Memberships	298

New Member:
Margaret "Mickey" Bazzano

New Life Members:
Lennart Ahlkvist
Leo E. Kalcic
John Arrillaga
Richard T. Peery

Association Officers and Executive Committee Members

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President	Craig Holden
Sergeant At Arms	John Viscovich
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Treasurer & Editor	Hilton Brown
Membership	June Casey
Programs & Publicity	Liz & Mario Ambra
Hospitality	Elizabeth Engberg
Memorial/Remembrance	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Pat Figueroa
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

Life Members

Honored Member
Chris Castro

Special Member
Lena Alameda

Life Members

Lennart Ahlkvist
Mario Ambra
May E. Armanini
John Arrillaga
Marge Hingsberger Bailey
Godfrey Baumgartner
Flora Brown
Hilton Brown
Mary Ann Meek Buswell
Alice Churin Carvo
June Casey
William A. Dale
June de Larios
Cliff Del Carlo
Joseph Diaz
Kevin C. Duggan
Doris Ebere
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Farvelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Carole Fischer
Tom Frankum
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Ed Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
Norene Hogle
Audry Jarvis Hoke
Alice D. Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
George Jagels
Harold Jarvis
Al Jehning
Leo E. Kalcic
R. Michael Kasperzak Jr.
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Barbara Krzyczkowska
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Thomas E. Miller
Frances Churin Mills
Eva Mockbee
Betty C. Monroe
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Don Newfarmer
Anne G. Nichols
Nancy Noe
Richard J. Peery
Harry Pinto
Ida Pinto
Milan Popovich
Massimo Prati
John P. Puppo
Patricia J. Reyburn
Mark Rogge
Vivian Schatz
Robert C. Schick
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Martin J. Spangler
Austin Spencer
Honor Spitz
J. R. Stafford
Brigitte Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Sally Moore Taboada
Hip Telmont
Edna Thompson
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Paula Weaver
Robert Weaver
Denise Williams
Bill Wissell
Mary Lou Zoglin

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

REGULAR MEETING

Sunday, May 6, 2001
2:00 PM
Senior Center - 266 Escuela

Celebrations

First Presbyterian Church
150 Years of Service

St. Joseph Catholic Church
100 Years a Parish Church

MEMBERSHIP: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW____ RENEWAL____
Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

Make Check Payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

MOUNTAIN VIEW
HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. BOX 252
MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042

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